

Norway Maple

Acer platanoides



Origin

Native to continental Europe and western Asia; brought to North America in the 1750s by botanist John Bartram and later planted extensively as a street tree.

Look for

Snap a leaf stem and look for a drop of milky white sap -- this is one of the few reliable ways to distinguish Norway maple from native maples at a glance, alongside its wide, dense crown.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf: five-lobed, hand-shaped leaf with a dense, geometric look; wide, dark crown.
- Sap: snap a leaf stem and look for a drop of milky white sap -- a reliable maple-only clue.
- Seed: paired winged samaras set at a wide, nearly flat angle.
- Commonly confused with: sugar maple (Norway maple's samaras spread at a flatter angle and its sap runs milky, not clear).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Small yellow-green flower clusters bloom before the leaves fully open.
Summer	Dense, geometric five-lobed leaves create heavy, dark shade.
Fall	Leaves turn yellow, often later than native maples.
Winter	Sharp, pointed end buds are visible on gray twigs.

DID YOU KNOW

- It's now considered invasive in many parts of the northeastern US and Canada because its dense shade and heavy seed production can crowd out native forest seedlings.
- Its seeds are paired samaras set at a wide, nearly flat angle -- a useful ID trait compared to the narrower angle of sugar maple seeds.